

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] I think I'll start now.

Speaker 2 [00:00:05] Go ahead.

Speaker 1 [00:00:06] So, before we begin the interview properly, I wanted to show you a document which is our consent form. And now that it's being recorded, I'll also ask for your permission for the recording, okay? But I'll quickly explain a few things before we start the interview. I'll share my screen. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:00:30] Yes, I can.

Speaker 1 [00:00:33] So, going through it quickly, we are conducting an exploratory study called A Multicultural Investigation on the Conceptualization and Measurement of Quality in Launching. Further down, we mention that if you agree to participate, the interview will last around 40 minutes and is completely voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time if you no longer want to participate. Here, we have two important parts. First, as you already gave me, I give my consent for the audio of the interview to be recorded. As you already gave me. And below, we have options regarding data sharing. It says here: I agree with how the data will be shared. We present basically two options. The first option is that there is a complete transcription. We transcribe everything that was said here, except for sensitive information that can be shared. And after the interview, you can see what the most sensitive information is. Or there is also an option here that is the transcribed excerpts. They can be shared as long as you are not identified. In both options, you remain anonymous. The only difference is that the first option is a transcription except for the most sensitive information, and the second option is a complete transcription. I wanted to know if you have any preference or if you want to choose another option that was not presented here, you can. Remembering, you can change this option. At the end of the interview, I will ask you again.

Speaker 2 [00:02:06] Again, at the end, right?

Speaker 1 [00:02:07] At the end.

Speaker 2 [00:02:09] But for the disclosure of the research, even when it is published, there will not be a complete transcription. It will probably be just that. Or if necessary.

Speaker 1 [00:02:21] This will not be disclosed. What we call shared data will only be among researchers. In this case, the details of the transcription itself, because the research results are gathered from everyone. But the transcription here is only among researchers. And again, anonymous. After that, it is not disclosed. Your identification is not disclosed.

Speaker 2 [00:02:46] The complete transcription is fine.

Speaker 1 [00:02:50] Okay. So I'll give you the final option. Remembering that if you want to change later, we can revisit it. And before we start, I just wanted to ask for your email because I need to send you this document. I can send it after the interview. I would like, if possible, for you

to send back the document indicating your consent and your choice of data option with your signature. Can that be done?

Speaker 2 [00:03:17] Yes, my email is [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:03:24] [redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:03:27] [redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:03:29] [redacted].

Speaker 2 [00:03:31] @gmail.com

Speaker 1 [00:03:35] Okay, [redacted], is it really like this? [redacted]?

Speaker 2 [00:03:38] Yes, that's right.

Speaker 1 [00:03:41] Okay, I already have your email. I'll send it, and after the interview, you can fill out the document and send it back with your signature. Well, I'll stop sharing my screen now. Let's start the interview. First, we have some basic questions about you. So, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:12] [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:04:13] [20-25]. How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:04:18] [1-5] years and [1-5] months.

Speaker 1 [00:04:24] Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:04:26] No.

Speaker 1 [00:04:28] Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:04:30] With my [family member].

Speaker 1 [00:04:32] Only him, right?

Speaker 2 [00:04:34] Only.

Speaker 1 [00:04:36] What is your main source of income, and what is your current profession?

Speaker 2 [00:04:41] I'm not working at the moment, but [occupation]. I have a degree in [program].

Speaker 1 [00:04:52] Before we start the questions about your relationship, I wanted to ask how you would like me to refer to your partner. Can it be "partner," "girlfriend," by name "[Name]," "companion?"

Speaker 2 [00:05:06] Either is fine. Whatever works.

Speaker 1 [00:05:11] So, the first question is, can you tell me more or less the love story of you two? Remember, the more details you can give me, the better. You don't need to worry about summarizing if you don't want to. You can give as much information as possible; it's even better for me.

Speaker 2 [00:05:26] We met at a party, at a club. Her cousin introduced us. I went that night with a friend. It was the second night that the club was open, and we got closer to their group without realizing it. One of them approached me and said she was interested, and we stayed together that night. We talked all night until it was time to leave. We exchanged phone numbers and [Social Media] and continued talking for a few days. At the time, I was still studying at [University], so we met once in person there. I think about [1-5] weeks later, we had our first date. We kept talking every day and meeting occasionally. Then I graduated, and we started seeing each other every [1-5] weeks or so. We didn't have anything serious, especially because I took a [exam] exam, which could have sent me to other cities. I didn't pass, so we continued our relationship, and our feelings grew. We started seeing each other every weekend. After [Event], we decided to be exclusive, about [6-10] or [6-10] months after meeting. We officially started dating [6-10] months after we met, so it was all very slow. But [1-5] months after we met, we already knew each other's families, as it was our birthday. Now we've been officially dating for a few months, have rings, and see each other every week, usually spending the whole weekend together.

Speaker 1 [00:08:16] How would you compare the quality of your relationship to those of your friends?

Speaker 2 [00:08:24] Most of my friends are single. Let me see. I think I have about [1-5] friends who have been dating for a few months. I think it's on par because I believe all my friends have healthy relationships, none are toxic. Our relationship, like theirs, involves a lot of conversation. I have a friend who has some problems with [redacted], but my relationship is better in that regard. We have no conflicts with our families. But overall, our relationship is healthy, much like my circle of friends.

Speaker 1 [00:09:20] I see. Can you explain why you think this? What do you see in your friends' relationships that makes you think they are healthy?

Speaker 2 [00:09:35] I see a lot of companionship. There's no toxic jealousy or anything like that. If someone feels uncomfortable about something, they talk about it and don't let it escalate. So, I think the dialogue is very open. I have a friend who lives in [Location] and when she comes here, she goes out with friends every day. In some relationships, this could be a problem, but her boyfriend doesn't mind, and she's fine with it. They have no conflict about it. Another friend of mine also always talks to me first if he has a problem, and then he talks to his boyfriend if something bothers him in the relationship. I think that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:10:38] I understand. How many romantic partners have you had?

Speaker 2 [00:10:47] [1-5] partners. I've had [1-5] relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:10:57] How do you compare the quality of your current relationship to your previous ones, and why?

Speaker 2 [00:11:07] Compared to the first one, I feel my current relationship has more quality. The first one was my first love, which we both rushed into, but there was a lot of immaturity despite being [16-20] years old. We didn't talk much, and I think that lack of dialogue caused our breakup. My current relationship has much more dialogue. We talk a lot and have a lot of companionship. If something happens, I always support her, and she supports me too. Compared to my last relationship, this one is healthier. I feel I've grown a lot as a person. My ex always wanted me to open up and talk, but I couldn't do it, so it was a bit toxic. We had some fights and even some emotional dependency. In my current relationship, I communicate much better. I'm the one who seeks to make the other person comfortable to open up and talk. So, I think the quality is higher, mainly due to my personal growth.

Speaker 1 [00:13:06] In general, what makes a relationship high quality or low quality? Can you give me concrete examples if you want.

Speaker 2 [00:13:17] Low quality would be a lack of trust, cheating (both sexual and emotional), lack of dialogue, which can poison us internally. And, of course, various types of violence. High quality would be open conversation and mutual understanding. There's no point in demanding the person to open up if you judge what they say. There has to be this openness and not seeing it as a personal attack. You have to understand that sometimes you might be wrong. I always try to listen to [Partner's Name] when she's upset about something and understand her feelings to improve myself. If something I did bothers her, I try to discuss it and see if she has anything to say. We can always improve communication. Both of us have some difficulty with it, but it's not something of low quality. It can always improve.

Speaker 1 [00:15:18] You mentioned the importance of trust, dialogue, and listening to the other's feelings. What do you think is most important in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:38] It's difficult. Let me think. I think sincerity, actually. For example, I talk to [Partner's Name] every day. When something happens, I tell her. There have been a few times when an old contact of mine has reached out. I could have chosen not to tell her, but I did because we talk every day, and I like to tell her everything. So, I always told her about these contacts and even offered to show her the messages if she wanted to see. She always appreciated my honesty. I think sincerity is above all.

Speaker 1 [00:16:46] This question is also important. What is love for you?

Speaker 2 [00:16:58] I think it's very subjective ... My perception of love has changed a lot over time. I used to read a lot of romance books and watch a lot of romantic movies, where the person can't live without the other, their heart races, and they instantly know they found their true love. I've been working on deconstructing this idea, especially in this relationship. I try to be more rational and understand that love isn't a fairy tale. I see love as something that brings

stability. It's someone you can trust, who you know will be there for you. Of course, it must be reciprocal. There are many types of love: romantic, friendship, family. I think it's like that, a calmness, not always a roller coaster.

Speaker 1 [00:18:21] I'll add a detail: you are the first person I've interviewed so far, and I've interviewed [6-10] people including you, who mentioned love not just as romantic love. You talked about family love, friendship. It's interesting how people often think of love only in terms of romantic relationships. But it's good. How important is love in a relationship to you?

Speaker 2 [00:18:57] I think it's the foundation of everything. I've heard a phrase that passion lasts a few months, but love lasts a lifetime. I think it's true. In the beginning, we're passionate, everything is intense, but love is something more stable. You need to know how to deal with this stability because it might seem boring, but it's not. It's having someone who knows you so well, who understands your feelings. So, the foundation of a relationship is this stability.

Speaker 1 [00:19:47] How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:19:53] She tells me every day. She puts up with my dramas. I'm a very dramatic person, and she always shows me affection. She tells me she misses me, and at the beginning of our relationship, she used to send me food and milkshakes. I might need to remind her of that, actually. But there are many ways she shows it physically too. We love physical contact, so even when we're having dinner with the family, there's always some part of us touching. These small demonstrations of care and respect.

Speaker 1 [00:20:47] Now I have some questions highlighting the issue of conflict. You mentioned there's no significant conflict with your families, but are there any other challenges you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:14] Challenges ... since we are a couple of two girls, there's the issue of homophobia. [redacted] So, there's that challenge. I don't know if it can be overcome in the future. I think about marriage and children, and my mother's family would be involved. Also, we need to improve our communication. Though it's good, it can go deeper than just day-to-day stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:22:40] Speaking of you and your partner specifically, are there any divergences or specific difficulties in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:06] I don't think so. But I've told her before, like, I wish we had a fight. We've never had a fight or a significant conflict. I think fights can bring hidden issues to light. But we've never had one. I've told her that before.

Speaker 1 [00:23:37] Would you say your relationship is good for you? Why?

Speaker 2 [00:23:44] Yes, it's good for me. It's like a lifeline in the middle of the ocean because sometimes I'm very stressed, and she provides stability. She's always there for me, keeping me

grounded. She's the person I talk to the most, the one I open up to the most. So, there's that positive reference of her for me.

Speaker 1 [00:24:27] Can you give a concrete example of this support?

Speaker 2 [00:24:41] Sure. My mom is moving, and I don't live with her. I live with my dad, but I go to my mom's place on weekends to help with the move. [Partner's Name] goes with me, stays at my mom's house to help. When my mom was looking for an apartment, [Partner's Name] went with her during the week since I couldn't go. They visited apartments together. That availability is very good.

Speaker 1 [00:25:15] I see. Do you believe your relationship has changed you? If so, how?

Speaker 2 [00:25:31] Yes, it has. Before meeting her, I was very much into partying and felt good without any commitments. We joke about this, how I thought I'd never settle down. But since we met, my social life changed. I only go out to parties if she's with me, otherwise, it feels dull. Even when we do go, we often end up wanting to go to bed early. So, she's calmed me down in that sense. We also do more cultural activities together, like going to museums and exhibitions, which I didn't do much before.

Speaker 1 [00:26:35] Do you believe your partner has also changed during your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:26:43] I think so. Sometimes I don't notice much, but there are small changes. She opens up more about her family or when something happens at home. She doesn't hide things and talks about them more freely.

Speaker 1 [00:27:19] In general, based on what you've highlighted as important in your relationship, do you feel secure in your relationship? What makes you feel secure?

Speaker 2 [00:27:33] I feel very secure. Emotionally, everything is very stable. We've never had crises of jealousy or fights. She's never done anything to make me feel insecure. I feel I can open up about various subjects and that she's stable, providing me with security.

Speaker 1 [00:28:21] Can you give a practical example of this feeling of security?

Speaker 2 [00:28:27] Sure. A recent example: I was preparing for a [type of exam] exam scheduled for [Day], and just yesterday, less than [71-75] hours before the exam, they changed the date to [1-5] weeks later. It disrupted my routine, and I immediately texted [Partner's Name] and called her to vent. I knew I could talk to her, and we would complain about it together. That support is significant.

Speaker 1 [00:29:16] I'll move on to a part where I'll share my screen again to show you a response scale. There will be some statements, and you'll understand quickly. I'll ask you to indicate your response. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:29:45] Yes, I can.

Speaker 1 [00:29:47] So, quickly. Here is the first statement: My partner really listens to me. On a scale from 1 to 9, where 1 is not true at all and 9 is completely true, how much do you agree with this statement?

Speaker 2 [00:30:15] I would say 8.

Speaker 1 [00:30:19] Same thing for the next statement. On a scale from 1 to 9, where 1 is not true at all and 9 is completely true, how much do you agree with this statement: My partner cares about my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:30:32] 9.

Speaker 1 [00:30:36] Can you explain why you chose 8 for the first statement, using an example if possible?

Speaker 2 [00:30:49] I'm often a person who gives hints. Sometimes I say something and expect her to understand the hidden message. So, it's about that. Sometimes I say something expecting a reaction and it doesn't always come as I want. For example, if I say I want chocolate but don't directly ask for it, she might not pick up on it. It's partly my issue too, not fully opening up. I tend to speak indirectly.

Speaker 1 [00:31:55] Similarly, can you explain why you chose 9 for the second statement?

Speaker 2 [00:32:06] I feel she genuinely cares about my needs. Whenever something happens to me, she shows concern and offers her support. She's always there for me, especially for my emotional needs.

Speaker 1 [00:32:32] I'll stop sharing the screen now and return to a few more questions. There are just two questions related to physical intimacy, if you're comfortable answering. These might be sensitive topics.

Speaker 1 [00:33:00] Have you been having sexual relations lately?

Speaker 2 [00:33:03] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:33:06] How satisfied are you with your sex life, and why do you feel that way?

Speaker 2 [00:33:15] [Redacted].

Speaker 1 [00:34:17] I understand. Now, I'll share the screen again for another statement. How satisfied are you with your relationship? Choose the response that best fits your feelings.

Speaker 2 [00:34:49] I'd say very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:34:52] Very satisfied, right? So, within your response, can you indicate a number from 0 (not satisfied) to 10 (completely satisfied) that best represents your satisfaction?

Speaker 2 [00:35:24] Eight.

Speaker 1 [00:35:27] Can you explain why you didn't choose 0 or 10, for example? Why 8?

Speaker 2 [00:35:41] I ruled out anything below 5 because I feel satisfied, but not completely. I see room for improvement, which is why I didn't choose 9 or 10. I believe we can reach 9 or 10, but it's rare to be completely satisfied. People claiming 10 might be overlooking issues. I see our relationship as good, but with room to grow. I'd like to see more spontaneity, breaking the routine a bit.

Speaker 1 [00:37:09] We're almost done with the interview. I'd like to summarize some key points you mentioned: the importance of dialogue, support, sincerity, trust, listening to each other's feelings, and companionship. You also noted communication as an area for improvement. Is there anything you'd like to add, anything I didn't ask that you wanted to talk about?

Speaker 2 [00:38:06] There's one question I like to ask when getting to know someone in a relationship: what would make you end the relationship? For me, it's infidelity. I wouldn't forgive or continue with someone who cheated. It's something I would totally cut from my life.

Speaker 1 [00:38:46] Great. Thank you for participating. I'll follow up on the data option you chose (complete transcription). You can still change it when you return the consent form. This research is being conducted in the US, Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, and France. We're in the initial interview phase. Could you recommend one or two people you know who might be LGBT and non-monogamous? I need one more interview with a couple fitting that category, but it's been hard to find.

Speaker 2 [00:40:22] I think my friend has a friend who's in a non-monogamous gay couple. I'll ask and let you know.

Speaker 1 [00:40:40] That would be great. Explain who I am and the interview, so they know who I am.

Speaker 2 [00:40:58] Okay, I'll ask them. I enjoyed participating in the research.

Speaker 1 [00:41:07] That's great! I'll send you the email with the document. You can send it back with your signature and any contacts you have.

Speaker 2 [00:41:29] Okay, sounds good.

Speaker 1 [00:41:31] Thanks, [Participant's Name]. I appreciate your participation. Thank you. See you.

Speaker 2 [00:41:39] See you. Good luck!

Speaker 1 [00:41:41] Thank you. Bye.



